Spaghetti squash with a spicy Oriental tomato sauce and cardamom rice

35 min active · ~55 min realistic (incl. prep) · 4 servings

Ingredients (for 4 servings)

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  → not counted — no nutrition match
- 2 spaghetti squash
  → Squash, winter, spaghetti, raw
- 200 g brown rice
  → Rice, brown, long-grain, raw (Includes foods for USDA's Food Distribution Program)
- 4 g cardamom pods (in spice jars)
  → Drumstick pods, raw
- 2 yellow onion
  → Onions, yellow, raw
- 1 Elstar apple
  → Apple, raw
- 360 g Sparc vegetable mince, seasoned with baharat
  → Croutons, seasoned
- 2 bunch coriander

→ not counted — no nutrition match

- 2 tin diced tomatoes
  → Tomatoes, canned, red, ripe, diced
- 2 tub spices
  → Spices, cardamom
- 1 orange
  → Orange, raw
- 2 stalk spring onions
  → Onions, spring or scallions (includes tops and bulb), raw
- Oil for frying (pantry)
  → Vegetable oil, NFS
- 100 ml water (pantry)
  → Water convolvulus,raw
- 4 garlic cloves (pantry)
  → Garlic, raw
- Extra virgin olive oil (pantry)
  → Olive oil

Preparation

Amounts in the steps are for 2 servings, as on crisp.nl.

Step 1

Preheat the oven to 220 degrees.

Step 2

Halve 1 spaghetti squash lengthwise, remove the seeds and

rub the inside with oil. Place cut-side down on a baking tray with baking paper. Prick the skin a few times with a fork. Slide into the oven for approx. 25 min.

Step 3
Place 100 g rice in a pan with slightly more than double the amount of water and salt. Crush 2 g cardamom pods and add them (without the pod) to the rice. Cook gently, covered, until tender and dry in approx. 20 minutes.

Step 4
Finely chop 1 onion. Heat oil for frying in a lidded frying or stewing pan and gently sauté. Peel and grate ½ apple (with a coarse grater). First, fry 180 g vegetable mince with the onion. Then, briefly fry the grated apple.

Step 5
Make the sauce. Roughly chop 1

bunch of coriander (reserve some for garnish). Blend the coriander, 1 can of diced tomatoes, 50 ml water, 1 container of spices, 2 pressed garlic cloves and a generous pinch of salt with a hand blender. Add the sauce to the mince and bring to the boil.

Step 6
Slice ½ orange into thin slices. Place in the sauce and let simmer gently, covered, for approx. 10 min.

Step 7
Cut 1 spring onion stalk into 1 cm pieces. Fry in a small frying pan until it starts to colour. Mix into the rice, along with a splash of extra virgin olive oil. Season with salt and pepper.

Step 8
Remove the squash from the oven and check with a fork if the flesh

easily comes away. Taste it, it will still have a bit of bite.

Step 9
Season the sauce to taste with salt and pepper. Place half a courgette on each person's plate. Let them carefully pull apart the strands with a fork and spoon the sauce over them. Garnish with the rest of the coriander and serve with the rice. Good to know: The spice tray for 2 people contains: 1 tsp ground cardamom, 1 tsp turmeric powder, 0.5 tbsp baharat and 2 cardamom pods. The tray for 4 people contains double the amount.

Chef's notes & cookware

- Your cookware plan: Use the oven for the spaghetti squash from preheating through baking. The medium pot is for cooking the

cardamom rice. The frying pan will be used for sautéing the onion, frying the mince and apple, and simmering the spicy tomato sauce. Use the air fryer for frying the spring onions in step 7, as your frying pan will be occupied with the sauce (steps 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9).

- Maximize parallel cooking by starting the spaghetti squash in the oven and the rice in the medium pot simultaneously. Once those are going, begin preparing your sauce in the frying pan to ensure everything finishes around the same time (steps 1, 2, 3, 4).
- Before you turn on any heat, complete your mise en place: chop the onion, grate the apple, crush the cardamom pods, press the garlic, chop the coriander (reserving some), and slice the

orange. Also, prep the squash by halving, seeding, oiling, and pricking it (steps 2, 3, 4, 5, 6).

- The sauce simmers for 10 minutes while the squash finishes in the oven; ensure you have the spring onions cut and ready to go into the air fryer as soon as the rice is done, so they can be mixed in fresh (steps 6, 7, 8).
- When checking the spaghetti squash, a fork should easily pull away the strands; aim for tender but still with a slight bite. Remember to season the sauce to taste before serving, and encourage guests to pull apart the squash strands themselves (steps 8, 9).

Nutrition (per serving)

Nutrient	Amount	% daily*
Macros		
Energy	882 kcal	44%

Protein	19.6 g	39%
Carbohydrate	144.2 g	52%
Sugars	20.8 g	—
Fiber	15.5 g	55%
Fat	27.4 g	35%
Saturated fat	6.3 g	32%
Minerals		
Calcium	296 mg	23%
Iron	6.6 mg	37%
Magnesium	191.4 mg	46%
Phosphorus	416.1 mg	33%
Potassium	1413.8 mg	30%
Sodium	1534.8 mg	67%
Zinc	3.2 mg	30%
Copper	0.6 mg	69%
Manganese	3.4 mg	146%
Selenium	36 µg	66%
Vitamins		
Vitamin A (RAE)	115 µg	13%
Vitamin C	54.9 mg	61%
Vitamin D	0 µg	0%
Vitamin E	2.5 mg	17%
Vitamin K	40 µg	33%
Thiamin (B1)	0.9 mg	75%
Riboflavin (B2)	0.6 mg	44%
Niacin (B3)	10.8 mg	68%
Vitamin B6	0.8 mg	44%
Folate (DFE)	217 µg	54%

Vitamin B12	0 µg	5%

* Percent of daily needs for a 2000 kcal diet (FDA Daily Values).